



Michigan is a folksy pop rock musical that follows Petoskey Vandam and Lulu Abughosh, a grieving Yoooper boy and Dearborn girl, fight a data center to save their grandparents' historic lake house.

Michigan

Inspired by
The MacGregor Family
David Quang Pham's Childhood

&

In Loving Memory of
Carly Glynn
September 24, 1992 - February 10, 2011
Tiffany Marie Emmert
April 29, 1996 - January 19, 2026
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Thanks to you all, David and countless others
love musical theatre and Michigan.

Michigan

SYNOPSIS

To save their grandparents' lake house from becoming a data center, a Dearborn girl and her grieving Yooper cousin must bridge their peninsula-sized rivalry, proving blood is thicker than the Mackinac Strait. To buy back the home, they must trade Petoskey's late father's treasured heirloom (a heart-shaped Petoskey necklace with an elk symbol) which Lulu lost in Pine River years ago. Petoskey, a native fossil that reveals its true pattern when wet, serves as a metaphor for hidden grief and emotional depth.

Michigan is inspired by David Quang Pham's upbringing and the MacGregors who invite him to their Elk Rapids lake house on Harbor Days since being roommates with their family member Lukas Jacob in 2014. In 2026, after a series of suicides of his hometown and college friends in musical theatre, he began writing this musical as a love letter to his family and communities in our home Mitten.

WHY NOW?

Michigan champions human creativity, connections, and nature against the rise of harmful technologies, symbolized by the threat of a data center replacing a small-town family's lake house. By centering the narrative on the impacts of suicide and collective loss, the play addresses today's mental health crisis, offering ways to heal through open communication and community. And it uses science and folklore to bridge regional cultural divides, reminding audiences to protect both the natural environments and our shared heritages that keep us rooted.

Michigan is *Oklahoma* craziness meets *Fun Home* tenderness meets *Bright Star* folksiness.

Michigan

THEMES

Collective Grief and Emotional Healing

The story explores the long-term impact of grief after Petey's suicide and Grandma Milly's death, demonstrating how silence fractures families while open communication fosters generational healing.

Community versus Technology

The central conflict pits a warm hand-made tradition against cold corporate greed, by keeping AI data centers from erasing local heritage, such as the family's lake house.

Geographic and Cultural Disconnection

The narrative highlights how families can become polarized by peninsulas, symbolized by the physical and emotional barrier of the Mackinac Bridge separating the Upper and Lower Peninsula identities. The story leans into subcultures, contrasting Yooper (Upper Peninsula) against suburban Dearborn/Lower Peninsula dynamics.

Belonging and Identity

Through Lulu's competitive drive to outshine her cousins, the musical examines the painful adolescent struggle to fit into a Midwest family dynamic and find one's own sense of worth.

Nature, Folklore, and Science Literacy

By embedding paleontology into the musical numbers, the narrative uses the natural history of the Petoskey stone fossil to teach environmental appreciation and show how memories attach themselves to physical landscapes.

Michigan

The Immigrant Experience

This manifests through multiple layers, such as Shelby marrying an Arab man, Jasper Tran's Vietnamese restaurant (Banh MiMichigan), and Jasper's realization that his refugee family stayed united across continents while local families are divided by peninsulas. It deals heavily with how different minority communities interact within the Midwest.

Economic Displacement and Xenophobia

The backstory reveals the harsh realities of blue-collar job loss during the 2008 recession, like David's family in the automotive industry. It directly addresses the displaced anger that can arise from automated or immigrant replacement (Petey being fired and replaced by a migrant worker), showing the tragic intersection of economic desperation, racial tension, and family fallout.

The Power of Hand-Made Artistry

The family's century-old Ford Model T, their decades of hand-made costumes, and the town's rally around them showcase art and weirdness as a form of liberation.

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PLOT SUMMARY

Michigan is a folksy musical dramedy set at a family reunion where two rival cousins fight a data center to save their grandparents' historic lake house. The themes explore grief, cultural disconnection of the peninsulas, and what it means to be a Michigander.

Grampy Willy and Granny Milly live in Elk Rapids on the north tip of the Lower Peninsula. They have four adult children – Cherry, Perry, Shelby, and the only son Petey, and some grandchildren. Every August, their lake house lodges them for the annual Harbor Days. The Vandam family are known for their century-old Ford Model T, wearing themed costumes for the parade, and winning every Most Creative Award (“[The Mitten Song](#)”).

In 2008, Petey lives with his pregnant wife Lizzie in the Upper Peninsula. His childhood friend is Jasper Tran, who runs the Elk Rapids Vietnamese restaurant, BANH MIchigan. On a swim, he jokily promises to name their kid after the first rock he picks up, which turned out to be a heart-shaped Petoskey with an elk symbol (“[Life is Complete](#)”).

With the recession, their shipyard job fires and replaces Petey and Liz with migrants. He then hurts his little sister Shelby due to her Arab husband. In a storm, he drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house on his life insurance. A detective finds his Petoskey. Ever since, Liz refuses to cross bridges, missing all family gatherings (“[Body of Water](#)”).

For family reunions, the aunts take turns driving Petoskey to Elk Rapids then Milly drives him home. Jasper becomes his godfather. For every Mackinac Bridge crossing, he can hear his dad sing. And then there's his bright cousin from Dearborn, Lulu Abughoush. She always competes to find the rarest stones on their swims (“[Yoopers and Trolls](#)”).

In 2020, Milly passes away, cancelling the 2020 and 2021 family reunions. Soon, data center developer Amy Wayland tricks a grieving Willy into signing away the deed to his house by using afterlife.ai to bring Milly and Petey back to life (“[It Would Be a Shame](#)”).

In 2022, to honor Milly, 13-year-old Petoskey's mother returns for the first time since the 2008 tragedy. They drive the long way through Wisconsin. Jasper helps Petoskey, Lulu, and the other kids set up camp and go canoeing with them. He often takes some of their snacks as “dad tax.” The aunties take even more with “mom taxes” (“[Dad Tax](#)”).

As Willy believes Milly and Petey stayed alive by AI, they discover Wayland's plot to turn Elk Lake into a data center. She and Cherry were art school rivals. She tours the home and sees a photo of baby Petoskey with his hearty stone. She wants it. Worth more than the city itself, the boy promises to trade it for the deed (“[AI Does the Work for Me](#)”).

They have a day to find the necklace along Pine River. Petoskey revisits a memory of him canoeing with Lulu in 2019 when she tossed his heirloom, severing his dad's spiritual ties. Petoskey enlists the cousins to help find it, promising whoever finds the heirloom gets to decide what Petoskey wears next year. But no one finds it (“[More than Fine](#)”).

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Later that night on a dune, Lulu and Petoskey witness deer pass by their bonfire. He wishes to see his dad while she hopes to beat Petoskey ("Dearborn"). Next day, while Perry teaches fossils to the kids ("Fossils in the Stones"), Lulu separates and discovers a deer drop off the heirloom and other rare rocks on the shore ("The Great Lakes Ballet").

For Harbor Days' parade, Broadway actor cousin Jacob Jacobowitz is the Grand Marshal. So, the theme is theatre. Petoskey dresses as *Oklahoma's* Jud Fry while Lulu plays Evan Hansen. Before marching, she shows her rare findings to the family. To spite Petoskey, she breaks his father's necklace, unaware it was their only chance to save the lake house from Wayland. The parade goes wrong as Petoskey beats up Lulu, disqualifying them for the first time ("Fraudway"). After a lecture, he runs away ("Kick Rocks").

In the following act, the family revisits a memory of Lulu and Petoskey meeting ("Hands Come in Handy"). Presently, they search for him while Lulu tries to find him at Banh MI ("Petoskey"). Jasper shares his refugee family stayed united despite continents dividing them as well as a time when a Lebanese family bought out his family's failing restaurant but did not resort to blame as Petey had. The Vandams are only divided by peninsulas. Lulu realizes Petoskey is most likely at the Mackinac Bridge ("North South East West").

They drive up to find him. She offers the broken stone as a truce, but he tosses it into the water ("Rock Bottom"). This causes the bridge to fog up where his father's ghost emerges as a giant elk. Petey shares that stones are special only when rocks are packed together. Like family, rocks come and go to leave a mark ("Family's in the Fossils").

They return to the fair where Wayland is exhibiting data center models with other developers. Petoskey offers the Ford which she scoffs but is interested in. Jasper then offers his restaurant. The Vandams return with decades of themed costume while Wayland shows how much "better" AI is. But the town rallies for this genuinely creative and weird family, against AI's goal of turning lakes into data centers. Wayland and the developers refuse and steal the Ford, causing the town to chase after them. She drives it off a bridge, then gets thrown into an asylum by Traverse City. Their contracts are declared void as their party is declared insane ("Leave No Stones Unturned").

After Harbor Days conclude, Liz takes the Ford for a spin and go the short way to the Mackinac Bridge, the first time since Petey's death. Liz and Petey's ghost have their own reunion as lovers once more ("[Water to My Soul](#)").

Years later, Willy passes away. Lulu and Petoskey buy and fix up the lake house. For the 2037 Harbor Days which celebrates two hundred years of statehood, the theme is Pure Michigan where the Vandam family resembles the state's best ("Michigan").

Michigan

CAST OF CHARACTERS

THE VANDAM FAMILY

PETOSKEY VANDAM is a 13-year-old farm boy from Skandia and the goofiest of Willy and Milly's grandkids. Besides his mom Liz, his only connection to extended family happens on Harbor Days in Elk Rapids. He never met his late father. To honor Petey, he wears his heart-shaped Petoskey heirloom with an elk symbol.

LIZZIE VANDAM is Petoskey's mother and narrator in Skandia. After her husband Petey's suicide in 2008, she stops crossing the Mackinac Bridge to attend Harbor Days and all family gatherings. Liz is a proud farm girl Yooper. Michigan State.

PETEY VANDAM is Petoskey's father, Liz's husband, and Willy and Milly's only son of four. Every Harbor Days, he would be the first to get up to wake everyone up. During the recession, his blue-collar shipyard job fires and replaces him and Liz with migrants, leading to a fight with his little sister Shelby for marrying an Arab. He drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house with his life insurance. His ghost visits Petoskey whenever he crosses the bridge. Michigan State.

LULU ABUGHOUSH is a 13-year-old city girl from Dearborn and the brightest of Willy and Milly grandkids, yet she is trollface personified. Despite going above and beyond, she and her mom Shelby feel out of place. She hopes to beat cousin Petoskey in their annual rare stone collection. She loves Iggy Pop and her favorite musical is *Dear Evan Hansen*. Her name means "pearl" in Arabic.

SHELBY ABUGHOUSH is Petoskey's aunt, Petey's little sister, and Lulu's mother who lives in Dearborn. She is an automotive worker for Ford Motor Company. As the sister who broke the mold by falling in love with an Arab, she and Petey had a tumultuous relationship. She tries to respect Petoskey. Kettering University.

PERRY VANDAM is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's older sister in Lansing. Her campy mind loves science. Michigan Technological University dropout.

CHERRY JACOBOWITZ is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's oldest sister in Kalamazoo. She arranges the theme and costumes for the annual Harbor Days parade. She is married to a Grand Rapids Griffins hockey manager. Hope College.

JACOB JACOBOWITZ is Cherry's son who is a successful Broadway actor in New York City. He is the Grand Marshal for the 2022 Harbor Days Parade where he is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*. He recently performed on the national tour of this show. Western Michigan alum.

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LIBERTY AND BAILEY are twin siblings and Petoskey, Lulu, and Jacob's little cousins removed from reality. They are from Hell... Michigan. Liberty is allergic to sand and Bailey is allergic to pine. They make poison ivy bouquets.

MILLY VANDAM is Petoskey's bold grandmother and inventor. She invented the automatic toilet. With Willy, she owns a house by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. She and Willy stumble into the audience every so often. Central Michigan University.

WILLY VANDAM is Petoskey's chill grandfather and gardener. With Milly, he owns a lake house by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. Grieving Milly's death in 2020, he leaves the garden unattended and accidentally signs away the deed. He and Milly stumble into the audience every so often. Northern Michigan University.

ELK RAPIDS RESIDENTS

JASPER TRAN is Petey's resourceful childhood friend and Petoskey's godfather who runs the BANH Michigan Vietnamese restaurant and a golf course. As a teen, he once looked down on the Arab community when a Lebanese family bought out his family's previous struggling restaurant. After Petey's death with his last memory being his prejudice towards Arabs for "stealing American jobs," he vows to help migrants no matter what. Ferris State. Red Wings fan.

AMANDA WAYLAND is the CEO of Turkey Ventures who created afterlife.ai whose goal is to turn the Elk Lake neighborhood into a data center. At Hope College, she was an art school rival of Cherry Vandam, before getting expelled for using Photoshop. So, she sees the Vandam family's hands-on creativity as inferior to the efficiency of AI. The Vandams describe her as a turkey vulture. But like most of the world, there is one thing she likes more than data and that is a cool rock, which Petoskey holds. Hope College dropout. University of Michigan (ew).

MICHIGANDERS

DETECTIVE is an investigator along the Mackinac Bridge.

THE GHOST OF HENRY FORD returns from real Hell during the Ford Model T car chase. He is punished for being antisemitic and anti-union. He tries to stop Wayland. After driving off a bridge, Lulu finds him and beats him up.

Michigan

MUSICAL NUMBERS

ACT I

1. [Overture / The Mitten Song](#) Petey
2. [Life is Complete](#) The Vandams
3. [Body of Water](#) Petey, Lizzie
4. [Yoopers and Trolls](#) Petoskey, Lulu
5. [It Would Be a Shame](#) Wayland, Willy, Milly, Petey
6. [Dad Tax](#) Jasper, Lizzie, Cherry, Perry, Shelby, Lulu, Petoskey, Kids
7. **Al Does the Work for Me** Wayland, The Vandams
8. **More than Fine (I'm Pine)** Petoskey, Lulu, Jacob, Liberty, Bailey
9. **Dearborn (Dear Deer)** Petoskey, Lulu, Deer
10. **Fossils in the Stones** Perry, Kids
11. **The Great Lakes Ballet** Company
12. **Fraudway** Company
13. **Kick Rocks** The Vandams

ACT II

14. **Hands Come in Handy** Lulu, Petoskey
15. **Petoskey** Company
16. **North South East West (As Long As You Try Your Best)** Jasper, Lulu
17. **Rock Bottom** Petoskey, Lulu
18. **Family's in the Fossils** Petey, Petoskey
19. **Leave No Stones Unturned** Wayland, The Vandams, Residents
20. [Water to My Soul](#) Lizzie, Petey
21. **Michigan** Company

👉 “Fossils in the Stones” is a David Quang Pham signature science song teaching paleontology.

ACT I

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS, AUGUST 2008 - DAY

1. "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

In the wooded backyard are tents where the Vandam family is camping and Elk Lake's rocky shores.

PETHEY (30s, man who's seen better days) crawls out of his tent. He puts on mittens. With a melodic yawn, he bangs pots and pans.

PETHEY

WAKEY WAKEY, SUN.
LET'S WEAR OUR MITTENS
AND COOK 'EM EGGS WITH LOTSA BACON
FOR OUR GODSEND,
MICHIGAN!

LIZZIE (30s, pregnant narrator) reluctantly crawls out of Petey's tent. She's one decibel away from smacking her husband, Petey.

PETHEY (CONT'D)

SLEPT WELL, HUN...?

End of "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

2. "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

LIZZIE

THAT'S THE LOVE OF MY LIFE.
BUT EVERY MORNING, HE'S PUBLIC ENEMY NUMBER ONE-
WHAT I MEANT TO SAY IS *PETHEY IS FAMILY TO EVERYONE*.

PETHEY

GET READY FOR IT'S...

SHELBY (V.O.)

LABOR DAY!

PETHEY

WHAT...? NO.

PERRY (V.O.)

APRIL FOOLS!

PETHEY

IT'S AUGUST.

CHERRY (V.O.)
HAPPY HALLOWEEN!

PETEY
WE'LL WEAR COSTUMES, BUT IT AIN'T HALLO-

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY (V.O.)
MERRY CHRISTMAS/HAPPY HANNUKKAH/JOYOUS KWANZAA!

PETEY
JESUS H. CHRIST.
LET'S INCLUDE BOXING DAY WHILE YOU'RE AT IT!

MILLY (V.O.)
Petey, don't be celebrating false holidays...

WILLY (V.O.)
We ain't 'em darn Canadians, eh.

PETEY
Ma, pa, remind Cherry, Perry, Shelby what week
it is.

CHERRY (V.O.)	PERRY (V.O.)
We're messing with ya,	Seeing you nerd out is sorta
pipsqueak.	hilarious.

SHELBY (V.O.)
Your singing sucks more as the years go by.

LIZZIE
The days of bullying your brother is over. It's
my time to shine!

Liz holds a hand to Petey's face.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Eh eh eh, talk to the hand.

Petey puts his hand above Liz's
like the Michigan peninsulas.

PETEY	LIZZIE (CONT'D)
MICHIGAN, IT'S HARBOR DAYS!	ELK RAPIDS, IT'S HARBOR DAYS!

GRANNY MILLY and GRAMPY WILLY are
lost, wandering in the audience.

MILLY	WILLY
GRAMPY WILLY.	GRANNY MILLY.

MILLY (CONT'D)	WILLY (CONT'D)
WE'VE GOT COMPANY.	REAL GOOD COMPANY.

Petey and Liz wave at Willy-Milly.

WILLY & MILLY
ISN'T LIFE SOMETHIN'?

MILLY
YOU HAVE COME A LONG WAY, FRIENDS.

WILLY
TO THE GREATEST BAY IN ALL THE GREAT LAKES!

MILLY
BAKED YOUR KIDS FRESH COOKIES,
MAKE YOURSELF COMFY.

Milly hands out cookies. Willy
remove his shoes, revealing his
clam-covered feet. The pit pukes.

WILLY
Emphasis on feet!

MILLY
Ugh! You're scaring the guests with your clam
feet!

WILLY
I've been working out. My feet have mussels. M-
U-S-S-E-L-S? Get it?

MILLY
...your dad jokes are getting old, Willy...

WILLY
Not as old as you, mama Milly...

MILLY
Shush! The guests are gonna think we're Midwest
silly instead of normal silly.

PETEEY
Ma! Pa! Who are you talking to???

LIZZIE
You should put ya parents in a retirement home.

WILLY & MILLY
Our hearing aids heard that! Maestro?!

Willy-Milly nod to the conductor.

WILLY & MILLY (CONT'D)
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH YOUR CRAZY FAMILY!

The three Vandam sisters - CHERRY,
PERRY, and SHELBY (pregnant) - run
out of their tents and chase their
brother, Petey. They catch him.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Hey Lizzie!

Cherry and Perry give Petey a wet
willy.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY (CONT'D)

WET WILLY!

PETEY

Ah!!! We're full grown adults!

LIZZIE

Nah dude, sisters always sisters.

Petey frees himself.

PETTY

GO MAKE YOUR DUMB COSTUMES, CHERRY.
PLAY WITH YOUR LAB EQUIPMENT, POINDEXTER PERRY.
WHERE IS YOUR WEIRD HUSBAND, BABY SISTER, SHELBY?

WILLY

Did someone say, wet... Uh...?

MILLY

Willy!

Milly?!

WILLY (CONT'D)

LIZZIE

No more singing Mitten Song and it'll all be over.

PETEY

Nevah!

VANDAMS

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT...

Willy brings out the Ford Model T.

WILLY

THE MODEL T!

MILLY

I'M GONNA TEABAG YOU, SO HELP ME, WILLY.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
DADDY LIKES HIS WHEELIES.

WILLY

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT MILLY!

CHERRY

CHERRY!

PERRY

PERRY!

SHELBY

SHELBY!

PETHEY

PETHEY AND HIS BESTIE...

JASPER (30s, Vietnamese man)
struts out of Petey's tent.

PETHEY (CONT'D)

Jasper! Got banh mi?

LIZZIE

Liz- Excuse me?

PETHEY (CONT'D)

You know Jasper Tran, we go way back!

JASPER

To the stone ages.

PETHEY

More like stoner ages, amirite?

LIZZIE

You two always being high, reminding everyone
you're childhood besties yadi yada...

JASPER

And that my fam owns the Viet restaurant, BANH
MIiiiiichigan!

PETHEY

Let's hit it up for ol' time sake!

MILLY

Lizzie, you needa give my son a hit!

PETHEY

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT MY WIFEY!

LIZZIE

LIZZIE!

SHELBY

AND OUR BABIES...

MILLY

OUR GRANDKIDS...

WILLY

AH! GRANDKIDS!

LIZZIE

Watcha naming your daughter?

SHELBY

Lulu!

LIZZIE

Lulu. So full of life! Any particular meaning?

SHELBY

It means "pearl."

PETEY

Arabic...? Ew.

SHELBY

And your ibnuki (إبنك)?

LIZZIE

No clue.

JASPER

I bet Petey's got an ace up his sleeves.

PETEY

More like *stone*.

Petey and Jasper hop into Elk Lake, splashing each other.

AMANDA WAYLAND (20s, all business)
briefly peaks in.

WAYLAND

Such a shame a happy family completes this lake house when it's missing something. I mean, look at this water. Disgusting. Freely flowing when it should be cooling my supercomputers. The air... too pure to breathe. It needs the spicy flavor of nuclear power. All families are incomplete without pure dread. The Great Lakes do bring out the worst. The Vandams will burst.

PETEY

We won't name our son. Elk Lake will...

JASPER

Jasper! Jasper! Jasper!

LIZZIE

This gotta be a joke...

Petey dives in and finds a heart-shaped, Elk-marked Petoskey stone.

Time stops. Everyone is in shock at this rare rock.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

WE AIN'T NAMING OUR SON THAT.

Liz walks off. Petey runs after.

JASPER

How about naming your second kid, Jasper?!

PETHEY
WE DON'T HAVE TO NAME HIM THAT.

LIZZIE
IT DOES SOUND LIKE PETHEY.

PETHEY
MY NAME JUST NEEDS AN O AND A KEY-

Liz kisses Petey.

LIZZIE
ISN'T LIFE BEAUTIFUL?

PETHEY (CONT'D)
ISN'T LIFE WORTH LIVING?

VANDAMS
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR

JASPER
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH THIS

LIZZIE
CRAZY

PETHEY
SASSY

CHERRY
WORKY

PERRY
NERDY

SHELBY
DERPY

WILLY
WILLY

MILLY
LOVELY

JASPER
WELCOMING...

VANDAMS
FAMILY!

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

Liz's phone rings. She answers.

LIZZIE
Thanks for giving us a sinking feeling!

Liz slams her flip phone.

PETHEY
Is it the baby?

LIZZIE

The recession got us too. The shipyard has
fired us and replaced us. 2008 can't get any
better. Those darn migrants.

Petey sees Shelby looking fondly
at photos of her Arab husband on
her phone.

PETEY

The outsiders hurt us, blue-collared workers.

LIZZIE

We're gonna lose our house to a foreclosure.
So, don't be burning bridges...

Petey sobs, as everyone leaves. He
looks as Elk Lake turns into the
Mackinac Strait under its bridge.

SCENE 2

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - EVENING

3. "BODY OF WATER"

Out in the rain storm, Petey walks
onto the foggy creaky bridge.

PETEY

EVERY LIVING THING IS MADE OF WATER.
EVERY MACHINERY NEEDS THE FLOW OF WATER.
ALL THE WEATHER TAKE THE HEATED WATER.
ALL THE SEASONS BRING THE COOLING WATER.

I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD UNLIKE WATER.
I'VE BROUGHT NOTHING TO THE WORLD BUT TEARS!

The Mackinac ghosts appear,
resembling those who passed there.
They try to hand a mug to Petey.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.

PETEY

I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

CHERISH. CHERISH THIS ONE LIFE.

PETEY

JUST TEARS!
HELP!

The ghosts steal Petey's stone.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

HELP? HELL, HELP YOURSELF!

A motherly ghost returns with a
Petoskey necklace. Petey wears it.

PETEY

I CHOOSE LIFE!

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)

TAKE IT IN.

PETEY (CONT'D)

DRINK THE GREAT LAKES WATER.

THINK PAIN. PAIN YOU'LL CAUSE.

HAPPY WIFE. BABY IN SIGHT. DYING AIN'T RIGHT.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.

THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.

CHERISH. CHERISH LIGHT.

PETEY

HELP MYSELF TO THIS GREAT WATER!

Petey drinks his mug, starts the
car, and drives away.

Morning approaches with the
emergency vehicles. The orchestra
wails the sirens.

Liz rushes in with the DETECTIVE.
She stops in her tracks, kneeling.

LIZZIE

Life is a complete... disaster...

DETECTIVE

We are sorry to report the vehicle submerged
underneath Mackinac Bridge has been identified
as yours... and the body-

LIZZIE

-NOW OF WATER.

IN THIS BODY OF WATER...

UNDER THE BRIDGE...

WITH MY LAST TEAR,

I'M OUTTA WATER IN MY BODY...

The Detective gives the Petoskey
necklace to Liz, then leaves.

End of "BODY OF WATER"

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

A bridge is supposed to unite two lands, not divide two souls. The water may be under it, I have vowed to never set foot on a bridge that double-crossed my heart. The strait stole my balance, silenced my music, drowned my love, eroded me into a cold, hard-

Shelby, now with a black eye and some bruises, hugs Liz. She encourages Liz to open her hand to reveal the Petoskey necklace.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Every rock has a softness they need to find in themselves. Perhaps, it'll take time in unexpected places... and persons... And yes, in the end, Petey got me to name our baby...

Liz places the necklace in the center. She leaves.

SCENE 3

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS, AUGUST 2019 - DAY

4. "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

PETOSKEY (11, farm boy) crawls out of his tent. He sees the Petoskey necklace and wears it. He puts on mittens and bangs pots and pans.

LULU (11, city girl in a Hijab) crawls out of her tent and trolls Petoskey.

LULU

...Petoskey!

PETOSKEY

Lulu!

LULU

Shut... up, Yooper!

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

Pipe... down, Troll.

Cherry, Perry, and Shelby enter with lawn chairs. They sit.

CHERRY

The kids are at it again?

SHELBY

With my daughter, you betcha.

PERRY

Let's be responsible... and place some bets.

SHELBY

Let's go Lulu! Your inheritance in on the line!

Petoskey takes off his mittens as
Lulu gives troll-like expressions.

PETOSKEY

HOLY WAH! ANOTHER DAY TO GO FISHING!

LULU

YEAH NO... TODAY, WE GO BIRD WATCHING.

PETOSKEY

AREN'T YOU FROM EH... DEARBORN?

LULU

I AIN'T INTO DEER, YOU WILD YOOPERS...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN.
YOOPERS AND TROLLS.

PETOSKEY

EH, CRAZY TROLLS...
LET'S GO STARGAZING!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

WHAT ABOUT 'EM MOSQUITOES?

LULU

LET'S JUST WATCH WCMU-TV!

PETOSKEY

WLUC IS UP THERE!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

WOOD-TV 8 IS BETTER! (MOSQUITOES!)

LULU

I WILL BITE. I AM DOWN TO GO KAYAKING!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN!
PINE RIVER, THE FASTEST IN MICHIGAN!

Petoskey draws his water gun, but
Lulu sprays him first.

PETOSKEY

ATTACK!

LULU
TOO SLOW!

PETOSKEY
I'VE GOT BACKUP!

JACOB JACOBOWITZ (young NYC
actor), LIBERTY and BAILEY (twins)
and the OTHER COUSINS (kids)
ambush Lulu with their water guns
before retreating.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
YOU WILL NEVER STAY DRY!
UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN!

PETOSKEY
THANK YOU, COUSINS!

LULU
IT IS A SIN TO TARGET YOUR FAVORITE COUSIN.

Jacob hands a towel to Lulu. They
hug before he exits. She dries up.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
(Repeating)
YOOPERS AND TROLLS.

LULU
HOLY CRAP, I HATE *HATE* CAMPING WITH YOU.

PETOSKEY
NO ONE LIKES YOUR HIP HOP TRASH.

LULU
TAKE IT BACK, COUNTRY BOY.

PETOSKEY
YOU FIRST, CITY GAL.

LULU & PETOSKEY
ANOTHER HARBOR DAYS...

LULU
...WITH THIS WILD YOOPER...

Lulu and Petoskey wrestle

PETOSKEY
STAY UNDER THE BRIDGE, TROLL!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
YOOPERS AND TROLLS FORM A BRIDGE!

WILLY & MILLY

STOP FIGHTING!

End of "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

Liz shares the family members.

LIZZIE

(Narrating)

If my Petoskey and his cousin Lulu weren't fighting, I'd assume they were abducted and replaced by aliens.

Their cousin Jacob Jacobowitz is making it on Broadway.

Then there are Liberty and Bailey. Twin cousins removed from reality who are from Hell... Michigan. I've heard from my in-laws that they are angels.

Liberty and Bailey go wild and chase everyone around.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

I don't remember the other names Petoskey mentioned. They got many cousins, aunts, uncles- I wish I could meet them all but that Mackinac. It's a bridge I cannot cross. Its watery depths crossed my heart and made many hope to die.

Cherry drives in. She puts on a Red Wings hockey shirt over Petoskey. Perry shoves Cherry out then gives him homework. Then Shelby shoves Cherry out and Lulu shoves Petoskey out the car. Then Granny Milly respectfully takes over and lets Petoskey in the car.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Fortunately, my son is able to and his aunties had no problem taking turns driving him from Skandia in the U P to the L P. After Harbor Days, Granny Milly would drive him home. He is said to hear a man's voice whenever they cross-

As Petey naps in the car, he awakens to Petey's song.

PETHEY (V.O.)

WAKEY WAKEY, SON...

Jasper takes over for Milly.

LIZZIE

Whenever Milly was feeling well, Petoskey was Jasper's problem.

Jasper drops off and goofs off
with Petoskey in Skandia. Liz
awaits them.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Boys... Then the real problem came in 2020. We didn't see it coming. We no longer saw another one of Milly's inventions from her automatic toilet to the electromagnetic pet hair remover. We no longer heard another idea from her. Grampy Willy cancelled the 2020 and 2021 family reunion. He wanted to grieve alone. I worry about him and the lake house. I'm thankful for our home, living off my Petey's life insurance. But no one can rest assured of what lives life will take away from us next. I really wanted to see everyone.

INT. HOME IN SKANDIA, JULY 2022 - DAY

Petoskey sits sadly, looking at
photos of Milly.

LIZZIE

Son, I know how much Grammy Milly meant to you. So, would it mean the world if I went to this year's Harbor Days? August two ol' two two.

PETOSKEY

You'd cross the bridge?

LIZZIE

Nah. We'll take the long way through Wisconsin.

PETOSKEY

That's not fair! Everyone's cheesy there...

LIZZIE

Let's get a MOOooooove on. For Milly's sake.

Liz and Petoskey exit.

SCENE 4

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

5. "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

Willy stares longingly at a photo
of his late wife Milly.

Amanda Wayland knocks on the door.
Willy goes and open it.

WAYLAND
I NEED YOUR LAKE HOUSE!

WILLY
YOU DAMN VULTURE.

MILLY (V.O.)
WHO ARE YOU CALLING A VULTURE?

Willy opens the door again.
Wayland nabs Milly's photo.

WAYLAND
AND YOU NEED YOUR WIFE BACK.
MY NAME'S AMANDA WAYLAND OF TURKEY VENTURES...
AND I CAN BRING YOUR WIFE TO LIFE!

Wayland displays her tablet.

WILLY
SHE DID NOT BELIEVE IN ALCHEMY.

Wayland places Milly's photo on
her tablet.

WAYLAND
THIS IS NOT ALCHEMY.
IT IS TECHNOLOGY!

Milly shows up behind Wayland.

MILLY
SO PROUD OF YOU.

WAYLAND
YOU HEARD THAT?

Wayland raises the tablet volume.

MILLY
I LOVE YOU!!

WAYLAND
I'D LOVE FOR YOU TO LET ME BUILD A DATA CENTER BY YOUR LAKE.
SO, SHE CAN GET THE WATER SHE NEEDS.

MILLY
DO NOT BRING SHAME.

Willy looks at the disapproving
violinists in the orchestra.

WAYLAND
DON'T BE ASHAMED TO SAY "NO."

WILLY
NO.

Milly disappears.

Wayland expects it. She "respects"
his decision. Before closing the
door, she nabs Petey's photo.
Outside, she sets it on her tablet.

Petey enters the home.

PETEY
WASN'T MY LIFE WORTH MORE THAN MY HOUSE?

MILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME...

PETEY
WASN'T MY BREATH WORTH MORE THAN SOME LAKE?

MILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME...

PETEY
WASN'T MY HEART WORTH MORE THAN THESE ROCKS?

WILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME IN FORGETTING THEM.

Milly joins Petey.

PETEY, MILLY, WAYLAND
SHAME...
SHAME...
ASHAMED...
ONLY SHAME...
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I CHOSE THE HOUSE BEFORE MY FAMILY!
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I MAKE...

WAYLAND
BRING BACK YOUR WIFE!

PETEY & MILLY
DON'T BE ASHAMED!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE...

PETEY & MILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME.

WAYLAND
BRING BACK YOUR SON!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE SAME...

PETEY, MILLY, WAYLAND
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY	WAYLAND
IT'D BE SHAME IF I MAKE THE	IT'D BE A SHAME IF YOU MADE
SAME MISTAKE...	THE SAME...

PETEY, MILLY, WAYLAND
IT'D BE A SHAME!

Milly and Petey vanish before
Willy could hug them. Instead, he
hugs a tablet with their photos.
The tablet displays a contract. He
holds the e-pen.

End of "[IT WOULD BE A SHAME](#)"

SCENE 5

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS, AUGUST 2022 - DAY

6. "[DAD TAX](#)"

Jasper finishes setting up Lulu
and Petoskey's tents.

Shelby and Lizzie stare in awe as
Lulu and Petoskey feel awful.

SHELBY
Thanks for everything, Jasper.

LULU
I really did not need your help.

PETOSKEY
You needed all the help you can get, Lulu.

JASPER
And you needed manpower.

LULU
Ha! He called you a sissy, Petoskey!

LIZZIE
How could we ever repay you?

JASPER

Your sweetness is good 'nough for me.

Jasper nabs a handful of candy
from Lulu and Petoskey's box.

LULU & PETOSKEY

That's *my* candy.

Lulu and Petoskey stare down one
another as they fight for the box.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

Mine! My sweets! Sugar! Mine!

Jasper takes their box away.

JASPER

In the jurisdiction vested by the council of
fathers and godfathers, everything is mine.

LULU & PETOSKEY

What jurisdiction?

Jasper pulls out his "Dad Rules!"
book. He opens it for the kids to
skim then promptly shuts it.

JASPER

YOU KIDS GOT NO SAY...

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

SO TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION?

JASPER

IT'S GOOD FOR THE COMMUNITY!

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

THAT'S WHAT A COMMUNIST WOULD SAY!

JASPER

JUST PAYA YOUR FAIR SHARE!

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

NEVER!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

DAD RULES!
TAX SEASON!
CAMP REASONS!
COME COLLECT:

The Vandam aunties tax and collect
from the kids on Jasper's behalf.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY (CONT'D)	LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS
YOUR COOKIES!	MY COOKIES!
YOUR CANDIES!	MY CANDY!
YOUR FRENCH FRIES!	MY FRENCH FRIES!
YOUR MILK SHAKES!	MY MILK SHAKE!
YOUR CHICKEN!	MY CHICKEN!
YOUR NUGGETS!	MY NUGGETS!
YOUR KID'S MEALS!	MY KID'S MEAL!
YOUR ROBLOX!	MY ROBLOX!
YOUR MINECRAFT!	MY MINECRAFT!
YOUR FREEDOM!	OUR CIVIL LIBERTIES!

JASPER
YOU'VE GOT TRANSPORTATION...
DRINKING WATER...

Jasper drinks the milk shakes.

JASPER (CONT'D)
THERE'RE NOW CAMP GOODS AND SERVICES...
ALL THANKS TO THE DAD TAX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
PAY YOUR DAD TAX!

[Liz sings about the mom tax. It is more egregious than the dad tax. The kids start a Boston Tea Party-esque revolution due to being dad and mom taxed without kid representation.]

End of "DAD TAX"

Jasper, the Vandam sisters, and
the kids gather by the bonfire.

JASPER
Looks like during the revolution, you all
started the fire! A perfect bonfire to honor
Grammy Milly. I'll go get Grampy Willy.

Jasper goes into the lake house.

LULU
One can only wish for a godfather like Jasper.

PETOSKEY
You just saw him and our moms tax us.

LIZZIE & SHELBY
We gave you welfare in the world, we can tax
you out of it.

Jasper enters with Willy. He pulls
up a chair.

JASPER

Why don't you have a seat here?

Willy sits. Everyone sit down.

CHERRY

We gather here today to honor the life of
Grammy Milly. It's been a couple years since
Milly left this world...

WILLY

Actually, Milly came back a couple days ago.

Everyone stares at Willy like an
old man who lost his marbles.

PERRY

Like in your dreams?

SHELBY

Putting him in a nursing home is gonna be a
nightmare.

Willy pulls out a tablet.

WILLY

Home is here. So is my favorite nurse... on
this phone.

PERRY

That's too big for a phone.

CHERRY

It's how big they were back then.

SHELBY

Dad, you can't just call the after life.

WILLY

Milly, please call.

Milly appears on the tablet.

MILLY

Way ahead of you.

Everyone is disturbed.

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

She looks so real!

WILLY

She is.

PERRY

No, she's not.

CHERRY

She... Don't break dad's heart again.

WILLY

You all have seen enough of your mama. I can ask Petey to call.

Liz covers Petey's eyes and ears.

LIZZIE

No no no.

JASPER

What did this cost?

WILLY

Very little.

CHERRY

How much?

WILLY

My son was worth more than...

LIZZIE

...the house...?!

Wayland slyly steps in.

WAYLAND

Yes, access to Afterlife dot AI was on the house. I see it's a perfect time to come in when everyone seems fired up. Cherry.

CHERRY

Amanda...

WAYLAND

How's making 'em kiddy costumes for your dumb Harbor Days parade?

CHERRY

How's making anything? That's right. You can't.

LULU

Who's she?

PERRY

Amanda Wayland was Cherry's classmate in Hope College art school.

CHERRY

Until she was caught cheating with Photoshop.

WAYLAND

And now everyone's using Photoshop.

SHELBY

Don't you use that, Cherry?

CHERRY

Shut up. I use Corel.

PERRY

You geezer. Who uses Corel?

WAYLAND

And I did complete my degree at U of M.

VANDAMS

Ew... The Wolverines.

KIDS

Rabies...

WAYLAND

Bite me. Now, everyone around the world depends on me to get through the day, answer questions smart and dumb, answer questions dumb and brilliant, read novels, write essays, entire musicals-

LULU & JACOB

Shut the f-

CHERRY & SHELBY

Language.

WAYLAND

I didn't get to the best part of. It does the impossible. It brings the dead to life.

PETOSKEY

Deadarse...

Everyone stares down Liz.

LIZZIE

We Yoopers do not police language.

CHERRY

Get out.

WAYLAND

You're impressed.

PERRY

Depressed. Seriously, get out.

SHELBY

Vamos!

JASPER

Willy, implore this amorally ambiguous woman to leave the premises.

WAYLAND

The premise is... I own your lake house.
There's a Willy, there's a way. Willy, thanks
for not making the same mistake your son made.

7. "AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME"

WAYLAND

CAN YOU AFFORD IT?

LIZZIE

You're wrong. He'd say the house is like family
and worth everything. How about my house near
Marquette?

PETOSKEY

Mom?

LIZZIE

Why would you want a rundown house when you can
have one with the latest amenities, including a
bidet?

[The family sings about affordability. They make reference to their century-old Ford Model T. No one could afford the house back. Wayland takes a tour of the home where it has walls of photos. She eyes a photo of a young Petoskey wearing his father's heirloom: a heart-shaped Petoskey stone with a marking of an Elk. Lulu and her mom Shelby are not present to know the importance of this stone to Petoskey and Liz. The lost heirloom is their only chance of saving the lake house. Wayland would trade the deed for it.]

WAYLAND

No one outgrows collecting cool rocks,
especially a Petoskey. This one seems like it's
worth a whole Great Lake.

LIZZIE

It's my husband's heirloom.

WAYLAND

The owner is dead. Now, it's worth two Great
Lakes. Unlike him, is it here?

CHERRY & PERRY

Somewhere...

WAYLAND

Perfect. Everything on the premise is also
mine.

PETOSKEY

It's not yours.

WAYLAND

Your son's trade should be in law.

LIZZIE

Really?

WAYLAND

No.

PETOSKEY

Grammy Milly gave it to me. It's her last gift.

WAYLAND

How about a trade?

PETOSKEY

The house...

WAYLAND

...for your cool rock. Well, produce it.

PETOSKEY

I wanna put on a show. I need a whole day.

WAYLAND

Tomorrow after the parade?

LIZZIE

Tomorrow after the parade.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Is the Petoskey back in Skandia?

PETOSKEY

Closer. At the bottom of Elk Lake.

LIZZIE

What'? How did that happen?

Petoskey imitates Lulu.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Lulu?

[They have a day to find the necklace along Pine River. Petoskey revisits a memory of him canoeing with Lulu in 2019 when she tossed his heirloom, severing his dad's spiritual ties. Petoskey enlists the cousins to help find it, promising whoever finds the heirloom gets to decide what Petoskey wears next year. But no one finds it ("More than Fine").

Later that night on a dune, Lulu and Petoskey witness deer pass by their bonfire. He wishes to see his dad while she

hopes to beat Petoskey ("Dearborn"). Next day, while Perry teaches fossils to the kids ("Fossils in the Stones"), Lulu separates and discovers a deer drop off the heirloom and other rare rocks on the shore ("The Great Lakes Ballet").

For Harbor Days' parade, Broadway actor cousin Jacob Jacobowitz is the Grand Marshal. So, the theme is theatre. Petoskey dresses as Oklahoma's Jud Fry while Lulu plays Evan Hansen. Before marching, she shows her rare findings to the family. To spite Petoskey, she breaks his father's necklace, unaware it was their only chance to save the lake house from Wayland. The parade goes wrong as Petoskey beats up Lulu, disqualifying them for the first time ("Fraudway"). After a lecture, he runs away ("Kick Rocks").]

END OF ACT I

ACT II**SCENE 1**

[In the following act, the family revisits a memory of Lulu and Petoskey meeting ("Hands Come in Handy"). Presently, they search for him while Lulu tries to find him at BANH MI ("Petoskey"). Jasper shares his refugee family stayed united despite continents dividing them as well as a time when a Lebanese family bought out his family's failing restaurant but did not resort to blame as Petey had. The Vandams are only divided by peninsulas. Lulu realizes Petoskey is most likely at the Mackinac Bridge ("North South East West").

They drive up to find him. She offers the broken stone as a truce, but he tosses it into the water ("Rock Bottom"). This causes the bridge to fog up where his father's ghost emerges as a giant elk. Petey shares that stones are special only when rocks are packed together. Like family, rocks come and go to leave a mark ("Family's in the Fossils").

They return to the fair where Wayland is exhibiting data center models with other developers. Petoskey offers the Ford which she scoffs but is interested in. Jasper then offers his restaurant. The Vandams return with decades of themed costume while Wayland shows how much "better" AI is. But the town rallies for this genuinely creative and weird family, against AI's goal of turning lakes into data centers. Wayland and the developers refuse and steal the Ford, causing the town to chase after them. She drives it off a bridge, then gets thrown into an asylum by Traverse City. Their contracts are declared void as their party is declared insane ("Leave No Stones Unturned").]

Liz gets in and starts up the Ford
Model T. Petoskey hops in.

LIZZIE

Son... We're taking the shortcut.

SCENE +

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - DAY

20. "WATER TO MY SOUL"

On the foggy bridge is the broken
Petoskey necklace.

Liz drives towards the outskirts
of the bridge. She motions for
Petoskey to stay put. She walks
alone on the bridge.

LIZZIE
WHEN? WHEN? WHEN? WHEN?
WHEN WILL I EVER LET GO?

MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHEN YOU OPEN YOUR EYES AND SEE THE PAIN SHOW...

LIZZIE	MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
WHERE? WHERE? WHERE? WHERE?	WHERE? WHERE?
WHERE DO ALL MY TEARS FLOW?	FLOW?

The ghosts step aside to reveal
Petey in all his glory.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
WELL YOU JUST HAVE TO ASK THIS POOR SOUL...

LIZZIE	PETHEY
MY POOR SOUL...	NOW A HAPPY SOUL...

LIZZIE & PETHEY
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

LIZZIE
WHERE YOU GO.

PETHEY
I'LL FLOW!

MACKINAC GHOSTS
NO MATTER WHERE I GO I WILL FLOW...

LIZZIE
UPSTREAM.

PETHEY
DOWNSTREAM.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

Liz and Petey kiss.

LIZZIE & PETHEY
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...
MY SOUL...
YOU ARE MY SOUL!

They share a final dance before he
hands his broken Petoskey necklace
to her. She joins Petoskey.

Liz and Petoskey wave as Petey
vanishes with the other ghosts
once more into the foggy bridge.

END OF ACT II

ACT III**SCENE 1****EXT. ELK RAPIDS, 2037 - DAY****21. "MICHIGAN"**

[Liz narrates, sharing the course of actions that take place between 2022 and 2037.]

Years later, Willy passes away. Lulu and Petoskey buy and fix up the lake house.

For the 2037 Harbor Days which celebrates two hundred years of statehood (January 26, 1837), the theme is Pure Michigan where the Vandam family resembles the state's best from Eminem, Aretha Franklin, Charles Lindbergh, Madonna, Malcolm X, Rosa Parks, Stevie Wonder.]

END OF MUSICAL